# Leave Policy

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| HR-001 | HR Operations | 3 | 2026-01-01 | Internal |

## 1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines paid leave entitlements for all full-time employees of Northwind Systems. Contractors and interns are covered by their agreements.

## 2. Annual Leave Entitlement

Annual leave increases with length of service, as shown in Table 1. Leave accrues monthly and is credited on 1 January each year.

| Length of service | Annual leave (days) | Maximum carry-forward (days) |
|---|---|---|
| Less than 2 years | 20 | 5 |
| 2 to 5 years | 24 | 10 |
| More than 5 years | 28 | 10 |

Carried-forward days expire on 31 March. Leave requests longer than 10 consecutive working days require approval from the department head.

## 3. Sick Leave

Employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 3 consecutive days. Unused sick leave does not carry forward.

## 4. Parental Leave

| Caregiver type | Paid leave | Must start within |
|---|---|---|
| Primary caregiver | 26 weeks | 6 months of birth or adoption |
| Secondary caregiver | 4 weeks | 6 months of birth or adoption |

## 5. Related Policies

See the Remote Work Policy (HR-003) for working from another country while on leave.